

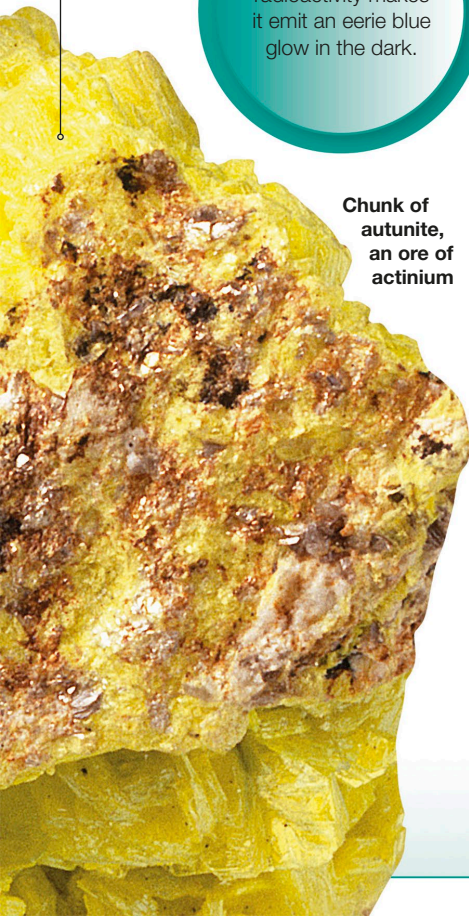
89
Ac

Autunite crystals range in colour from bright yellow to green.



Actinium's radioactivity makes it emit an eerie blue glow in the dark.

Chunk of autunite, an ore of actinium

90
Th

Thorium

Named after Thor, the Norse god of thunder, thorium is the most common radioactive metal in Earth's rocks. The heat from thorium's decay deep inside Earth keeps the planet warm, along with the Sun's heat.

ATOMIC MASS 232.038

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1829 (Baron Jöns Jacob Berzelius)

Piece of thorianite, an ore of thorium

91
Pa

Protactinium

The name of this highly radioactive metal means "before actinium", because uranium decays first into protactinium, which then breaks down into actinium.

Green crystals of torbernite, an ore of protactinium, in rock

ATOMIC MASS 231.036

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1913 (Kasimir Fajans and Otto Göhring)

